

- A hands-on workshop for the operations team

Getting Started with AI: Building Copilot Agents

A hands-on session where you'll use Microsoft 365 Copilot on your own real work and build a simple agent of your own — so you can take the repetitive tasks off your plate and keep going on your own afterwards.

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This is the first of several hands-on sessions with your team. Today covers the foundations — using Microsoft 365 Copilot in your day-to-day work and building your first simple agent. Later sessions build on it, each on a different part of what you do.

FOR

Operations —
fintech startup

DATE

Wednesday 3rd
March 2026

FORMAT

One-to-one, in your
own M365

DURATION

Half-day, ~3.5 hrs
(incl. break)

HOW WE RUN IT

Hands-on, one to one. You'll spend most of the session working on your own real task while I guide you. We'll use the tools you already have: Microsoft 365 Copilot across Outlook, Word, Excel and Teams, and Copilot Studio to build your agent. Everything you make is saved so you can reuse it afterwards.

BY THE END OF THIS SESSION, YOU WILL

- Know when to use Microsoft 365 Copilot day to day and when to build a purpose-built agent — and why.
- Use Microsoft 365 Copilot to complete a real operations task end to end across your apps.
- Build your own simple agent in Copilot Studio, grounded in your team's process — a workflow you built and can rebuild.
- Write prompts that produce accurate, usable output — ready to use or send with minimal editing.
- Keep building on your own afterwards, with everything you make saved so you can reuse it.

BEFORE THE SESSION, YOU WILL NEED

- A Microsoft 365 Copilot licence, signed in. Check you can open Copilot in Word, Outlook and Teams.
- Your laptop, signed in, with access to Outlook, Word, Excel, Teams and SharePoint.
- One real, repetitive task you'd normally do by hand, plus any process notes, templates or examples you follow.

AGENDA

09:30 – 09:45

Welcome & what today gives you

A quick round of the room and the goal: you leave able to use Copilot and build a simple agent yourself — not just watch a demo.

09:45 – 10:05

The landscape: Copilot and agents — when to use what

A plain-English map of both, with operations examples of each:

- Microsoft 365 Copilot — your everyday assistant in Outlook, Word, Excel and Teams: ask, draft, summarise and pull out what matters.
- A built agent (Copilot Studio) — a narrow, repeatable task you set up once and reuse, like an assistant that drafts standard customer responses.

10:05 – 10:50

Pair-build 1 — real work with Microsoft 365 Copilot

We sit together on the real task you brought — you drive, I guide. For example: draft a customer reply in Outlook, summarise a long email thread or policy, or make sense of a messy spreadsheet in Excel.

- Give Copilot clear context and say exactly what you want.
- Work right where you already are — in Outlook, Excel and Teams.
- Iterate on the result, and always review before you use it.

10:50 – 11:10

Break — grab a coffee

11:10 – 12:10

Pair-build 2 — build your own agent in Copilot Studio

You build it, I guide — a repeatable task your team does over and over, so you leave with a workflow you can rebuild:

- Ground it in your process and tone — the steps you follow and how you word things.
- Give it clear formatting rules so the output comes back consistent and ready to use.
- Test it on a real request, then save it to the shared library so you and the team can reuse it.

12:10 – 12:40

Making it stick: prompting, process and keeping output usable

The techniques that separate a rough draft from something you can publish:

- Prompt patterns that work, and reusable templates for your common tasks.
- Feeding an agent your process rules and templates so you edit less.
- Reviewing outputs, approvals, and keeping customer and financial data safe.

12:40 – 13:00

Wrap-up & next steps

We close by making sure you can keep going on your own:

- A quick recap of what you built and how you'll use it.
- Agree your next step — rebuild one agent this week on a task of your own.
- Where to get help between now and the next session.

WHAT YOU'LL TAKE AWAY

You will leave the session with:

- An operations-specific prompt guide — ready-to-use prompts for the tasks your team does most: customer replies, summarising threads and policies, and working with spreadsheets.
- A short how-to guide for building your own agents in Copilot Studio.
- The agent you built today, saved to a shared library so you and the team can reuse it.